

# Kant — MCQ Solutions

**Philosophy Optional | Paper I | Western Philosophy | Topic 04**

Open only after attempting the corresponding question. Every solution preserves the canonical answer, four option explanations and a question-specific examiner trap.

# MCQ SOLUTION INDEX

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## MCQ 1. What "transcendental" means in Kant

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Consider the following statements about Kant's use of the terms *transcendental* and *transcendent*.

1. A transcendental enquiry concerns the a priori conditions under which objects can be given to us.
2. A transcendent employment of the categories carries them beyond all possible experience.
3. Kant's own philosophy is transcendent, and the errors he diagnoses are transcendental.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: it keeps the correct account of transcendental enquiry but attaches Kant's own label to the wrong side, which is exactly the error statement 3 contains. - **B:** Correct: transcendental concerns conditions of possible experience and is legitimate, while transcendent means crossing beyond experience and is the source of dialectical illusion. - **C:** Incorrect: statement 2 is right, but pairing it with the inversion in statement 3 leaves the candidate calling Kant's method transcendent. - **D:** Incorrect: statements 1 and 2 cannot be combined with statement 3, since 3 reverses the very distinction the first two draw.

**Examiner trap 1:** Using "transcendental" and "transcendent" interchangeably destroys the Dialectic, because Kant's whole diagnosis is that reason slides from the first to the second. Fix the discrimination in your first paragraph and the rest of the script is protected.

## MCQ 2. What Hume actually did to Kant, and where Kant says it

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Which one of the following statements about Hume's role in the genesis of the critical philosophy is **accurate**?

- A. Kant says in the *Critique of Pure Reason* that Hume awoke him from his dogmatic slumber.
- B. Kant rejects Hume's analysis of experience and shows that necessary connexion is perceived after all.
- C. Kant treats Hume as a dogmatist whose confidence in reason had to be curbed by criticism.
- D. Kant says in the *Prolegomena* that the recollection of Hume interrupted his dogmatic slumber.

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the remark belongs to the Preface of the *Prolegomena* of 1783, not to either edition of the *Critique*, and "awoke" is a loose rendering. - **B:** Incorrect: Kant concedes Hume's negative point about experience entirely and relocates necessity to the conditions of objective time-determination instead. - **C:** Incorrect: Hume is Kant's model of consistent empiricism and the antidote to dogmatism, not an instance of it. - **D:** Correct: the German verb is *unterbrach*, "interrupted", and the sentence appears in the *Prolegomena* Preface.

**Examiner trap 2:** Attributing the "dogmatic slumber" sentence to the *Critique* is a visible provenance error. Name the *Prolegomena*, give the year, and mark the translation.

### MCQ 3. The analytic/synthetic distinction and the empty cell

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Which one of the following is **correct** about Kant's cross-classification of judgements?

- A. Analytic a posteriori judgements cannot exist, since containment makes experience idle.
- B. Synthetic a priori judgements are precisely those whose denial is self-contradictory.
- C. Analytic judgements are ampliative, since they make explicit what was only implicit.
- D. Synthetic a posteriori judgements are strictly universal because they generalise over cases.

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: if the predicate is already contained in the subject-concept, analysis alone settles the judgement, so no experience could be required. - **B:** Incorrect: it is precisely characteristic of a synthetic judgement that its denial involves no contradiction, which is why intuition must be called in. - **C:** Incorrect: analytic judgements are explicative rather than ampliative; making implicit content explicit adds no new determination. - **D:** Incorrect: empirical judgements can achieve only comparative universality, since no exception has been met so far.

**Examiner trap 3:** Naming the empty cell proves that you have understood the classification as a **cross** of two independent distinctions rather than one distinction with four labels. It costs a single clause.

### MCQ 4. Kant's two marks of a priori cognition

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According to Kant at B3–4, which pair of features marks a cognition as a priori?

- A. Clarity and distinctness of ideas
- B. Simplicity and immediate self-evidence
- C. Necessity and strict universality
- D. Certainty and psychological indubitability

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: clarity and distinctness are Descartes' criteria of truth, and Kant's argument nowhere relies on them. - **B:** Incorrect: simplicity and self-evidence are marks associated with intuitive first principles in the rationalist tradition, not Kant's tests for apriority. - **C:** Correct: a judgement is a priori if it is thought together with the impossibility of its being otherwise and admits no possible exception. - **D:** Incorrect: certainty is psychological and can attach to well-attested empirical beliefs, so it cannot distinguish a priori from a posteriori warrant.

**Examiner trap 4:** Strict universality is the sharper of the two criteria, because an empirical generalisation may be exceptionless as it happens without being exceptionless by entitlement. Write that sentence and the difference is secured.

## MCQ 5. Why " $7 + 5 = 12$ " is synthetic

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Kant argues that " $7 + 5 = 12$ " is a synthetic judgement principally because

- A. the concept of the sum of seven and five contains only their union and not twelve
- B. the judgement is verified by counting objects and is therefore drawn from experience
- C. arithmetical propositions can be denied without contradiction and might have been false
- D. the equality sign asserts a real relation between two independently existing quantities

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: to reach twelve one must go beyond the concept and call in intuition, which is precisely what makes the judgement ampliative. - **B:** Incorrect: counting is the appeal to *pure* intuition, and Kant insists that the result is necessary rather than empirically established. - **C:** Incorrect: Kant holds arithmetical truths to be necessary; the possibility of denial without contradiction concerns judgement form, not truth-value. - **D:** Incorrect: this reads the proposition as a claim about existing quantities and abandons the question of the judgement's own warrant.

**Examiner trap 5:** Candidates who defend the example by saying "we learn it by counting" have converted Kant's showcase of the synthetic **a priori** into an empirical generalisation and lost the point of the section.

## MCQ 6. The exact content of the change of standpoint

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Which one of the following states Kant's hypothesis at Bxvi–xviii **without distortion**?

- A. Things in themselves conform to the categories of the human understanding.
- B. Objects, as objects of possible experience, conform to our a priori forms.
- C. The human mind creates the objects it perceives entirely out of its own resources.
- D. Cognition must conform to objects, which is why a priori knowledge is impossible.

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: Kant expressly exempts things in themselves, and extending the claim to them would reinstate the contradiction he is trying to remove. - **B:** Correct: the restricting clause is part of the hypothesis, not a later qualification added under pressure. - **C:** Incorrect: what is contributed is form; the matter of sensation is received, and empirical objects are given rather than manufactured. - **D:** Incorrect: this is the assumption Kant proposes to abandon, and he cites its failure as the reason for the experiment.

**Examiner trap 6:** Quoting the slogan without its restricting clause invites the examiner to read Kant as an idealist about the world itself. The clause is six words long and it is the difference between Kant and the caricature.

## MCQ 7. The 2023 printed sentence and Kant's own formulation

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The 2023 Paper I question prints: "Precepts without concepts are blind and concepts without precepts are empty." Which one of the following is the **correct** handling of this line?

- A. Silently replace the printed line with Kant's own formulation and answer from that.
- B. Treat the printed line as Kant's own exact words, since it appears in an official paper.
- C. Refuse to answer this part at all, since the quoted sentence misrepresents the *Critique*.
- D. Quote the paper as printed, then give Kant's A51/B75 wording and note the substitution.

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: correcting the paper without acknowledgement conceals the discrepancy and forfeits the chance to display textual control. - **B:** Incorrect: Kant's formulation is "Thoughts without content are empty, intuitions without concepts are blind", and "precepts" stands where "intuitions" should stand. - **C:** Incorrect: the question asked is about the reconciliation of rationalism with empiricism, and that question is perfectly answerable. - **D:** Correct: quoting as printed, restoring the original and noting the substitution demonstrates accuracy without appearing to lecture the examiner.

**Examiner trap 7:** The four-step handling — quote, restore, note, answer — is worth marks in itself, and it takes two sentences. Never silently correct an official paper.

## MCQ 8. Which arguments of the metaphysical exposition do which job

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In the metaphysical exposition of space, which grouping correctly matches the arguments to what they establish?

- A. Arguments 1 and 3 establish apriority; arguments 2 and 4 establish intuitivity.
- B. All four arguments establish apriority, and intuitivity is established separately.
- C. Arguments 1 and 2 establish apriority; arguments 3 and 4 establish intuitivity.
- D. Arguments 2 and 3 establish apriority; arguments 1 and 4 establish intuitivity.

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the singularity argument is the third, not the first, and the non-empirical argument is the first, not the third. - **B:** Incorrect: the exposition assembles its conclusion from both pairs, and the transcendental exposition presupposes rather than supplies intuitivity. - **C:** Correct: space is not derived from experience and cannot be thought away, which yields apriority; and there is one space whose parts are limitations, given as an infinite magnitude, which yields intuitivity. - **D:** Incorrect: this scrambles the pairs and leaves the crucial fourth argument attached to the wrong conclusion.

**Examiner trap 8:** Listing four arguments without sorting them describes the exposition instead of explaining it. Say which pair delivers apriority and which delivers intuition, and the structure of the 2019 answer writes itself.

## MCQ 9. The transcendental exposition and its historical qualification

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Which one of the following most accurately states the position of Kant's transcendental exposition of space after the rise of non-Euclidean geometry?

- A. Non-Euclidean geometry refutes the claim that space is the a priori form of outer sense.
- B. Non-Euclidean geometry leaves the transcendental exposition of space entirely unaffected.
- C. Non-Euclidean geometry shows that space is after all a discursive concept, not an intuition.
- D. Non-Euclidean geometry weakens the argument from geometry, not the metaphysical exposition.

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the general claim that our experience has a priori spatial form is not settled by which geometry describes physical space. - **B:** Incorrect: the transcendental exposition explicitly leans on the apodictic status of one geometry, so the loss of uniqueness does damage it. - **C:** Incorrect: the singularity and infinite-givenness arguments turn on features no development in geometry has touched. - **D:** Correct: the argument from geometry lapses while the metaphysical exposition and the general form-claim survive.

**Examiner trap 9:** Stating this qualification pre-empts an objection the examiner is likely to have in mind, and it distinguishes the damaged argument from the surviving one instead of conceding everything at once.

## MCQ 10. Transcendental ideality with empirical reality

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Match Kant's two claims about space with what each of them blocks.

1. Transcendental ideality — 2. Empirical reality

I. It blocks the charge that space is an illusion or a private fancy. II. It blocks both Newton's self-subsistent containers and Leibniz's confused relations among things in themselves.

Which of the following is the correct matching, and what follows?

- A. 1–II, 2–I, and the two claims must always be stated together
- B. 1–I, 2–II, and the two claims must always be stated together
- C. 1–II, 2–I, and the second claim is a later concession
- D. 1–I, 2–II, and the first claim alone captures transcendental idealism

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: ideality denies that space determines things in themselves, which removes both rivals, while empirical reality affirms its objective validity for every appearance. - **B:** Incorrect: the matching is inverted, since it is ideality and not empirical reality that disposes of Newton and Leibniz. - **C:** Incorrect: empirical reality is asserted in the Aesthetic itself and is defended again in the Refutation, so it is no concession. - **D:** Incorrect: quoting ideality alone is precisely what makes Kant look like Berkeley to an examiner.

**Examiner trap 10:** The commonest single-sentence error in scripts is to quote the ideality and omit the reality. Write the pair as one clause and the Berkeley charge can never be raised against your answer.

## MCQ 11. The derivation of the categories

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Consider the following statements about Kant's metaphysical deduction.

1. The categories are derived from the logical functions of judgement, on the premise that the understanding is a faculty of judging.
2. The hypothetical form of judgement yields the category of causality and dependence.
3. The third category in each group is an entirely independent concept unrelated to the first two.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 2 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: it drops the worked example that shows the derivation to be systematic rather than merely asserted. - **B:** Incorrect: statement 3 contradicts Kant's own observation about how the third concept in each group arises. - **C:** Correct: the derivation rests on the judging premise, and the hypothetical form applied to a manifold given in time becomes the causal rule. - **D:** Incorrect: Kant notes that totality is plurality as unity, limitation is reality with negation, community is reciprocal causality and necessity is existence given through possibility.

**Examiner trap 11:** A table reproduced from memory earns very little. Derive one category from its logical form in a single sentence and the whole table becomes an argument.

## MCQ 12. Metaphysical deduction versus transcendental deduction

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Which one of the following correctly distinguishes the two deductions?

- A. The metaphysical deduction argues from apperception; the transcendental deduction argues from the table of judgements.
- B. The metaphysical deduction identifies the categories; the transcendental deduction justifies their application.
- C. The metaphysical deduction concerns space and time; the transcendental deduction concerns the categories.
- D. The metaphysical deduction is found only in the A edition; the transcendental deduction only in the B edition.

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the two methods are exactly reversed, since the table of judgements belongs to the identification and apperception to the justification. - **B:** Correct: the first answers *quid facti* and the second answers *quid juris*, which is why they cannot be merged. - **C:** Incorrect: space and time are treated in the Aesthetic, and neither deduction is about the forms of intuition. - **D:** Incorrect: both chapters appear in both editions, though the Deduction is substantially rewritten at B129–69.

**Examiner trap 12:** Confusing the two deductions is listed as a standing trap in every Kant guide, and it is easy to avoid with a four-word formula: identification versus justification.

## MCQ 13. What the transcendental unity of apperception is

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Which one of the following best states Kant's doctrine of apperception?

- A. It is the standing possibility that the "I think" accompany all my representations.
- B. It is the empirical consciousness of oneself obtained by careful inner observation.
- C. It is the simple, permanent soul-substance that the act of thinking is said to reveal.
- D. It is the bundle of perceptions that Hume claimed to discover by careful introspection.

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: Kant's modal formulation at B131–2 requires only that the "I think" be *able* to accompany them, not that it always does. - **B:** Incorrect: apperception is not observed at all, since it is the condition of anything being observed as mine. - **C:** Incorrect: inferring a substance from the formal unity is precisely the paralogism Kant exposes. - **D:** Incorrect: the bundle is a content found within experience, whereas apperception is a condition of experience.

**Examiner trap 13:** Dropping the modal phrase "must be able to" converts Kant's claim into the absurd suggestion of a continuous inner commentary. Quote the phrase as Kant writes it.

## MCQ 14. "Understanding makes Nature"

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Which one of the following is **not** part of what Kant means by the dictum that the understanding makes nature?

- A. Categories supply the a priori rules under which a manifold can count as objective nature.
- B. Nature, formally considered, is the law-governed unity of appearances.
- C. Sensations alone are unordered and must be synthesised to yield objects.
- D. The understanding produces the particular empirical laws that science discovers.

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect as an answer, because supplying the a priori rules of objectivity is exactly what the dictum asserts. - **B:** Incorrect as an answer, because the formal restriction is the doctrine's central qualification. - **C:** Incorrect as an answer, because the need for synthesis is the premise from which the dictum follows. - **D:** Correct: particular laws remain empirical discoveries, and Kant secures only the universal form of nature a priori.

**Examiner trap 14:** The mark is earned by the distinction between universal form and particular law. Without it the dictum sounds like the claim that physics could be done from the armchair.

## MCQ 15. Schema and image

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Which one of the following correctly states Kant's distinction between a schema and an image?

- A. The schema is a faint mental image, while the image itself is a vivid one.
- B. The schema is a rule of construction, while the image is a particular product.
- C. The schema belongs to sensibility, while the image belongs to the understanding.
- D. The schema is empirical, while the image is pure and given wholly a priori.

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: vividness is a difference of degree among images and does not touch the rule-product contrast at all. - **B:** Correct: any drawn triangle is determinately scalene or equilateral, whereas the schema is the procedure for constructing a triangle in general. - **C:** Incorrect: images are products of the imagination working in sensibility, and the schema is produced by the same faculty as a rule. - **D:** Incorrect: transcendental schemata are a priori determinations of time, and it is images that are particular and given.

**Examiner trap 15:** Writing that "the schema is a mental picture resembling both the category and the appearance" loses the section outright, because it reinstates the very heterogeneity the schema was introduced to bridge.

## MCQ 16. Why time and not space supplies the schemata

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Kant holds that the mediating schemata must be determinations of time rather than of space because

- A. time is more fundamental than space in the order of Kant's own exposition
- B. spatial relations are less exact and less measurable than temporal relations
- C. time is the form of inner sense and therefore present in every representation
- D. space is empirically real whereas time is transcendently ideal in Kant's system

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: order of exposition is a matter of presentation and could not by itself establish a claim about the conditions of subsumption. - **B:** Incorrect: exactness is irrelevant, since the requirement is universality of presence rather than precision of measurement. - **C:** Correct: outer objects are in space, but inner states are not, so only time satisfies the requirement of being contained in every appearance. - **D:** Incorrect: both space and time are transcendently ideal and empirically real, so this contrast is simply false.

**Examiner trap 16:** The asymmetry between space and time is stated in the Aesthetic and cashed in the Schematism. Flagging it early and using it later shows architectural understanding rather than recall.

## MCQ 17. The three Analogies

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Match each Analogy of Experience with the mode of time it determines and the proxy it supplies.

1. First Analogy — 2. Second Analogy — 3. Third Analogy

I. Succession, secured by a causal rule. II. Simultaneity, secured by thoroughgoing reciprocity. III. Duration, secured by a persisting substratum.

Which of the following is the correct matching?

- A. 1–I, 2–II, 3–III
- B. 1–II, 2–III, 3–I
- C. 1–III, 2–I, 3–II
- D. 1–I, 2–III, 3–II

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: it assigns succession to the First Analogy, which in fact secures duration through the persistence of substance. - **B:** Incorrect: it makes the Second Analogy the source of duration and the Third the source of succession, reversing both. - **C:** Correct: duration requires a persisting substratum, succession requires a causal rule, and simultaneity requires mutual causal community. - **D:** Incorrect: it correctly places simultaneity third but misassigns duration and succession between the first two.

**Examiner trap 17:** The three Analogies are not three examples chosen at random; they exhaust the three modes of time, which is why there are exactly three. Say so and the section acquires necessity.

## MCQ 18. The house and the ship

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In the Second Analogy, what exactly does the contrast between viewing a house and watching a ship drift downstream establish?

- A. That mere succession of perceptions cannot constitute perception of an objective succession
- B. That the perception of a house is instantaneous while the perception of a ship is extended in time
- C. That objective events are perceived more vividly than merely subjective sequences of perception
- D. That the imagination reverses the order of perceptions whenever the object perceived is at rest

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: apprehension is successive in both cases, so the difference between the two must lie in the necessity of the order rather than in succession itself. - **B:** Incorrect: both apprehensions take time, and Kant's point depends on their both being successive. - **C:** Incorrect: vividness is a Humean criterion of impressions and plays no role in Kant's argument for objectivity. - **D:** Incorrect: the reversibility in the house case is a matter of what the perceiver may choose, not of any reversal performed by the imagination.

**Examiner trap 18:** Using the ship without the house destroys the argument, because it is the **contrast** and not the moving object that shows why a rule is required.

## MCQ 19. Strawson's objection and the correct adjudication

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Which one of the following states the defensible verdict on Kant's Second Analogy against Hume?

- A. Kant proves the particular causal laws that Hume had declared to be unknowable.
- B. Kant secures entitlement to the concept of cause but leaves causal laws empirical.
- C. Kant fails entirely, since Strawson shows the whole argument to be a non-sequitur.
- D. Kant relocates necessity into the objects, where Hume had simply failed to find it.

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: Kant never claimed to derive particular laws, and doing so would contradict his own separation of form from content. - **B:** Correct: the concept of cause is shown not to be a bastard of the imagination, while which causes operate remains a matter for science. - **C:** Incorrect: Strawson's charge targets the step from determined order of apprehension to causal necessitation, not the whole enterprise, and Allison offers a reply. - **D:** Incorrect: necessity is located in the conditions of objective time-determination, not in perceived objects.

**Examiner trap 19:** "Kant answered Hume" is a slogan until you say **how much** of Hume's demand was met. The entitlement-versus-particular-laws sentence is the single most transferable line in this topic.

## MCQ 20. The negative noumenon

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Which one of the following correctly describes Kant's noumenon in the negative sense?

- A. An object of a non-sensible intellectual intuition available to all finite minds
- B. A hidden object that causes our sensations while itself remaining unobserved
- C. An illusory appearance that empirical criteria eventually expose as deceptive
- D. A limiting concept marking where sensible intuition ceases to yield knowledge

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: that describes the *positive* noumenon, and Kant denies that human beings possess intellectual intuition. - **B:** Incorrect: this is Jacobi's objection about noumenal affection, and asserting it as Kant's own doctrine is the commonest Kant error in scripts. - **C:** Incorrect: illusion is distinguished from reality *within* the field of appearances by empirical criteria, and has nothing to do with the noumenon. - **D:** Correct: the negative noumenon is a *Grenzbegriff* whose whole function is to forbid the extension of the categories beyond experience.

**Examiner trap 20:** The noumenon marks the edge of the screen, not a second object behind it. Open with appearance-is-not-illusion and the whole subtopic stays clean.

## MCQ 21. Regulative and constitutive uses of the Ideas

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Consider the following statements about the three Ideas of Reason.

1. The Ideas of soul, world and God correspond to the categorical, hypothetical and disjunctive relations respectively.
2. Used regulatively, the Ideas direct enquiry toward systematic unity and are legitimate.
3. Used constitutively, the Ideas yield theoretical knowledge of a soul-substance, a world-totality and God.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1 and 3 only

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the constitutive use is precisely what Kant denies, since it is the source of the Paralogisms, Antinomies and failed proofs. - **B:** Correct: the Ideas are derived from the three relations and are indispensable as maxims of systematic enquiry. - **C:** Incorrect: it correctly affirms the regulative use but then grants exactly the constitutive employment the Dialectic refutes. - **D:** Incorrect: it pairs a correct derivation with the illegitimate constitutive claim and omits the regulative employment altogether.

**Examiner trap 21:** Writing that the Ideas are "useless fictions" is as wrong as treating them as objects. They are perfectly good instructions and perfectly bad objects, and both halves earn marks.

## MCQ 22. The fallacy in the Paralogisms

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The Paralogisms of rational psychology are fallacious, according to Kant, because they

- A. rely on premises drawn from experience that turn out on inspection to be false
- B. presuppose the very conclusion about the soul that they had set out to prove
- C. equivocate between the "I" as logical subject and the "I" as a real object
- D. infer a universal conclusion from an insufficient number of observed instances

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the premises are not empirical at all, which is what makes rational psychology a purely a priori discipline. - **B:** Incorrect: circularity is a different fault, and Kant's charge is specifically that the middle term shifts its sense. - **C:** Correct: from the fact that I must think of myself as the subject of my thoughts, nothing follows about what I am. - **D:** Incorrect: hasty generalisation is an inductive fault, whereas a paralogism is a formal error in a syllogism.

**Examiner trap 22:** Using the word "paralogism" without naming the fallacy is decoration. Say **equivocation**, identify the shifting term, and the answer becomes diagnostic.

## MCQ 23. When reason enters antinomy, and how the four divide

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Which one of the following is **correct** about the Antinomies?

- A. Pure reason enters antinomy when it treats the world-series as an object in itself, and the mathematical antinomies have both sides false.
- B. Pure reason enters antinomy whenever it applies the categories to appearances, and all four antinomies receive exactly the same resolution.
- C. Pure reason enters antinomy because the phenomena–noumena distinction mechanically generates contradiction, and both sides are always true.
- D. Pure reason enters antinomy when the understanding oversteps sensibility, and the dynamical antinomies are resolved by declaring both sides false.

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: the demand for the unconditioned becomes antinomial when read constitutively, and the world-whole, never being given as complete, is neither finite nor infinite. - **B:** Incorrect: applying the categories to appearances is their legitimate employment, and the two classes receive different resolutions. - **C:** Incorrect: the distinction is the cure rather than the cause, since it is transcendental realism about appearances that generates the conflict. - **D:** Incorrect: it misidentifies the faculty at fault and attaches the mathematical verdict to the dynamical pair.

**Examiner trap 23:** Giving one resolution for all four antinomies is the commonest structural error at 20 marks. Mathematical: both false. Dynamical: both may be true. Say why — homogeneous versus heterogeneous series.

## MCQ 24. The dependency among the three God-proofs

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Which one of the following correctly states Kant's structural claim about the speculative proofs?

- A. Each of the three proofs stands or falls entirely on the strength of its own evidence.
- B. The ontological proof depends on the cosmological, which depends on the design proof.
- C. The design proof succeeds in establishing an omnipotent creator from the order of nature.
- D. The design proof needs the cosmological, which needs the ontological, so all fail.

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: independence is exactly what Kant denies, and denying it is what allows a single refutation to be decisive. - **B:** Incorrect: the dependency runs in the opposite direction, since the ontological proof is the terminus rather than the starting point. - **C:** Incorrect: Kant grants at most an architect who orders pre-existing material, since a finite effect licenses only a proportionate cause. - **D:** Correct: design must borrow an infinite or necessary cause, and the cosmological proof must identify its necessary being with the most real being.

**Examiner trap 24:** Treating the three proofs as three separate exercises doubles the length of your answer and halves its force. State the dependency chain in one sentence and refute once.

## MCQ 25. Remedial — what Kant does and does not prove about God

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A candidate writes: "Kant's critique of the three proofs establishes that God does not exist." What is wrong with this?

- A. Nothing at all; Kant is an atheist and says so in the second-edition Preface.
- B. Kant establishes that God exists, but only by way of the design argument.
- C. Kant establishes that the very concept of God's existence is self-contradictory.
- D. Kant establishes only that God's existence cannot be demonstrated theoretically.

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the second-edition Preface says the opposite — knowledge was denied in order to make room for rational belief. - **B:** Incorrect: the design argument is the one Kant treats most respectfully and still finds unable to reach an infinite creator. - **C:** Incorrect: Kant argues that denying God's existence involves no contradiction, which is a claim about logic, not about God's impossibility. - **D:** Correct: the position is theoretical agnosticism combined with a practical postulate, never atheism.

**Examiner trap 25:** The sentence "Kant is theoretically agnostic, not atheistic" costs six words and prevents an examiner from reading your whole answer as a misunderstanding.

## MCQ 26. Remedial — noumena and Plato's Forms

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Why is it wrong to gloss Kant's noumena as equivalent to Plato's Forms?

- A. Plato's Forms are sensible particulars, whereas noumena are universals.
- B. Plato's Forms are knowable by reason, whereas noumena are precisely unknowable.
- C. Plato's Forms are unknowable, whereas noumena are known through pure intuition.
- D. Plato's Forms exist in time, whereas noumena exist outside space only.

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the Forms are not sensible particulars on any reading, and the contrast misdescribes both doctrines. - **B:** Correct: the resemblance is only that both lie beyond sense, and the epistemic verdicts on them are exactly opposite. - **C:** Incorrect: this inverts both positions, since Kant denies that we possess the intellectual intuition such knowledge would require. - **D:** Incorrect: Kant's point is not a location claim, and describing noumena as existing "outside space only" reintroduces the second-object picture.

**Examiner trap 26:** Superficial resemblances between traditions are attractive and expensive. If you draw the comparison at all, draw it in order to mark the difference.

## MCQ 27. Remedial — the Refutation of Idealism and the "scandal" footnote

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Which one of the following is correct about the Refutation of Idealism?

- A. It was added in the second edition of 1787, and the "scandal" remark is a Preface note.
- B. It appeared in the first edition of 1781, and the "scandal" remark is in the Refutation.
- C. It was added in 1787 and is directed principally against Berkeley's own dogmatic idealism.
- D. It appeared in 1781 and proves the existence of things in themselves outside us in space.

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: the Refutation occupies B274–9 and the remark stands at Bxxxix note, in the Preface rather than in the proof. - **B:** Incorrect: both claims are wrong, since the section is B-only and the remark is a Preface footnote. - **C:** Incorrect: Berkeley is answered by the Transcendental Aesthetic, while the Refutation proper is directed at Descartes. - **D:** Incorrect: the objects proved are empirically external appearances in space, not things in themselves.

**Examiner trap 27:** Edition-specific material is a cheap source of visible error. The Refutation and the B-Deduction are B-only; the original Fourth Paralogism is A-only.

## MCQ 28. Remedial — the two resolutions must not be merged

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A candidate resolves all four antinomies by saying that thesis and antithesis are true in different realms. Where does this go wrong?

- A. It is correct for all four, since every antinomy turns on the phenomena–noumena distinction.
- B. It is wrong for all four, since Kant declares both sides false in every one of the cases.
- C. It is correct only for the dynamical antinomies; the mathematical antinomies have both sides false.
- D. It is correct only for the mathematical antinomies; the dynamical antinomies have both sides false.

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the mathematical antinomies concern a homogeneous series, where no second standpoint is available to divide the claims between. - **B:** Incorrect: the third antinomy's resolution is precisely that natural determination and spontaneous causality can both hold, of different standpoints. - **C:** Correct: heterogeneity of the series in the dynamical pair permits compatibility, while the world-whole in the mathematical pair is simply no object. - **D:** Incorrect: this reverses the two verdicts and would leave freedom excluded by the very resolution meant to make room for it.

**Examiner trap 28:** The classification is not decoration; it *determines* the resolution. State the reason — homogeneous versus heterogeneous conditions — and the two verdicts stop looking arbitrary.

## MCQ 29. Remedial — substance, alteration and coming-to-be

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According to the First Analogy, what is the correct description of change in the world of appearances?

- A. Substances come into being and pass away, and this is what change means.
- B. Change is an illusion, since the persistence of substance excludes all alteration.
- C. Substance persists, and what we call change is the alteration of its states.
- D. Both substance and its states persist, and only our perceptions alter.

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: coming-to-be and passing-away of substance is exactly what the Analogy denies, since time-determination would then have no proxy. - **B:** Incorrect: alteration is affirmed, not denied; it is precisely the changing of determinations against a persisting bearer. - **C:** Correct: what changes are accidents, and substance does not change but *has* changing states. - **D:** Incorrect: making the alteration merely perceptual would collapse the objective/subjective distinction the Analogies exist to ground.

**Examiner trap 29:** The distinction between *alteration* of states and *coming-to-be* of substance is the whole content of the First Analogy. Losing it turns Kant's argument into a bare assertion that things last.

## MCQ 30. Remedial — the "Copernican" analogy

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A candidate writes that Kant's Copernican revolution places the human being at the centre of the universe. What is the correct correction?

- A. Kant does place the knower at the centre, but only within the practical philosophy.
- B. Kant uses the phrase "Copernican revolution" himself at Bxvi, so the reading is authorised.
- C. The analogy concerns the centre of the solar system, which Kant relocates to the mind.
- D. Copernicus displaced the earth from the centre; the analogy is about explanation.

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the practical philosophy is not in view at Bxvi, and importing it compounds the original confusion. - **B:** Incorrect: Kant invokes Copernicus but the label "Copernican revolution" is the commentators', not Kant's self-description. - **C:** Incorrect: no centre is being relocated at all, since the comparison is about how apparent phenomena are explained. - **D:** Correct: Copernicus explained apparent celestial motion by moving the observer, and Kant explains a priori knowledge by the constitution of the knower.

**Examiner trap 30:** The popular reading inverts the very comparison it claims to use. One clause about the direction of explanation removes the error and displays the provenance caution at the same time.

## MCQ 31. Remedial — what the Third Antinomy establishes about freedom

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Which one of the following states what Kant's resolution of the Third Antinomy actually achieves?

- A. It proves that human beings actually possess transcendental freedom.
- B. It shows that freedom is thinkable without contradiction alongside determinism.
- C. It refutes natural determinism as it operates in the phenomenal world.
- D. It establishes that freedom and natural causality are two names for one relation.

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: a theoretical proof of freedom is exactly what Kant denies is available to speculative reason. - **B:** Correct: the antithesis holds of appearances while spontaneous causality remains conceivable of the same agent considered as noumenon. - **C:** Incorrect: Kant reaffirms the Second Analogy for appearances and does not weaken it in the slightest. - **D:** Incorrect: identifying them would dissolve the distinction of standpoints on which the whole resolution depends.

**Examiner trap 31:** "Room, not proof" is the four-word formula. Writing that Kant proves freedom converts a careful resolution into an over-claim the examiner will notice immediately.

## MCQ 32. Remedial — the owner boundary in a God-proof answer

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In answering a question on Kant's critique of the proofs for God's existence, which one of the following is the correct treatment of Kant's moral philosophy?

- A. Confine it to the practical postulate of God, and do not expand into ethics.
- B. Devote a full section to the categorical imperative, since morality grounds Kant's theism.
- C. Omit all reference to practical reason, since only theoretical reason is printed in the clause.
- D. Replace the theoretical critique with the moral argument, which Kant regarded as decisive.

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: the owner permits the practical postulate as a bounded consequence of the failure of speculative proof, and no further. - **B:** Incorrect: the categorical imperative, the good will and autonomy are Kantian ethics and are not printed in this syllabus item. - **C:** Incorrect: omitting the postulate loses Kant's own positive doctrine and leaves the answer looking like a bare negation. - **D:** Incorrect: the question asks about the critique of the speculative proofs, and replacing it answers a different question.

**Examiner trap 32:** Two sentences on the postulate, then stop. A God-proof answer that becomes an ethics survey has left the printed clause, and length will not compensate for scope.

## MCQ 33. What the Refutation of Idealism establishes

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Consider the following statements about Kant's Refutation of Idealism.

1. Determinate awareness of one's inner states in time presupposes relation to something persistent in outer experience.
2. The argument makes inner and outer experience epistemically co-dependent rather than deriving the outer world from an isolated inner certainty.
3. Its conclusion concerns empirically external objects in space, not cognition of things as they are in themselves.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only

- B. 1, 2 and 3
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1 and 3 only

**Answer: B.**

**Statement analysis:** - **1 is correct:** inner change can be determined in time only through relation to something persistent, which inner intuition alone does not provide. - **2 is correct:** Kant reverses Cartesian priority by arguing that determinate self-experience already depends on outer experience. - **3 is correct:** the proof establishes objects outside us in empirical space, not noumenal knowledge of things independently of our forms of cognition.

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: it captures the transcendental dependency but omits the decisive restriction on what kind of external object is established. - **B:** Correct: all three statements preserve both the anti-Cartesian force and the transcendental-idealist limit of the argument. - **C:** Incorrect: it states the conclusion and structure but omits the persistent-outer condition that performs the proof. - **D:** Incorrect: it keeps the premise and limitation while suppressing the co-dependence that distinguishes Kant from an inference out of inner certainty.

**Examiner trap 33:** Writing that Kant proves things in themselves outside us turns the Refutation into a violation of the very limit it presupposes. The conclusion is empirical externality.

**Repair action:** Reconstruct four links: inner states occur in time → temporal determination needs persistence → persistence is encountered in outer experience → empirical outer objects are immediately experienced.

**Coverage-cell mapping:** Refutation of Idealism — specifically the co-dependence of inner and outer experience without proof of things in themselves.

**PYQ linkage:** Supports the idealism boundary needed in **2019 Q4(a)** and **2020 Q3(c)**, while preventing an overclaim in any Kant–Berkeley comparison.

## MCQ 34. The noumenon as a limiting concept

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Consider the following statements about a noumenon in Kant's negative sense.

1. It marks the thought of something insofar as it is not an object of sensible intuition.
2. It licenses no determinate knowledge of a hidden object causing appearances, because categories without temporal schemata lack objective employment.
3. Its limiting role blocks the inference that appearances exhaust reality without converting the boundary into a positively known second world.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only

D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: D.**

**Statement analysis:** - **1 is correct:** the negative noumenon is thought by abstracting from our sensible mode of intuition. - **2 is correct:** unschematised categories may be thought logically but cannot determine an object beyond possible experience. - **3 is correct:** the concept limits sensibility and theoretical knowledge without supplying descriptive access to a noumenal realm.

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: it states the negative definition and epistemic limit but omits why a limit is retained rather than appearances being declared exhaustive. - **B:** Incorrect: it captures the non-knowledge and boundary but omits the precise negative definition of noumenon. - **C:** Incorrect: it states the negative thought and limiting role while omitting the schematism-based reason positive knowledge fails. - **D:** Correct: all three statements keep the noumenon thinkable, non-cognitive and boundary-forming without making it a hidden causal object.

**Examiner trap 34:** “The noumenon is the hidden thing that causes appearances” converts a limiting concept into a constitutively known object and triggers Jacobi's affection problem.

**Repair action:** Use three negatives: not sensibly intuited; not positively determined by categories; not a second world known behind appearances.

**Coverage-cell mapping:** Phenomena and noumena — specifically the negative noumenon as limiting concept rather than a positively known hidden causal object.

**PYQ linkage:** Directly sharpens **2020 Q3(c)** and the noumenal-boundary axis required by **2026 Q4(b)**.

## MCQ 35. The finite reach of the design proof

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A candidate argues that the order of nature proves an infinite necessary creator without borrowing any premise from another proof. Kant's strongest correction is that

A. finite order supports at most a proportionate architect; reaching a creator and necessary being requires the cosmological step and ultimately the ontological argument

B. purposive order proves an infinite creator directly, but the proof fails only because existence is known through inner rather than outer sense

C. the design proof establishes a necessary being, whereas only the move from necessity to personality depends on the cosmological argument

D. natural order is wholly illusory under transcendental idealism, so no empirical observation may support even a limited theological inference

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: an observed finite arrangement licenses only a proportionate designer or architect; creatorhood, infinity and necessity are imported through the dependency chain. - **B:** Incorrect: the design proof never reaches an infinite creator directly, and the inner/outer-sense distinction is

irrelevant to its failure. - **C:** Incorrect: necessity is precisely what the empirical design inference cannot yield without the cosmological proof. - **D:** Incorrect: appearances are empirically real, so order can support a limited inference even though it cannot ground speculative theology.

**Examiner trap 35:** Admiration for the design proof is not endorsement. Kant calls it the oldest and clearest route while denying that a finite effect can establish an infinite creator.

**Repair action:** Draw the dependency chain: order → architect only; creator/necessity → cosmological borrowing; *ens realissimum* with necessary existence → ontological borrowing.

**Coverage-cell mapping:** Critique of the physico-theological proof — specifically its finite-cause limitation and dependence on cosmological and ontological arguments.

**PYQ linkage:** Directly strengthens **2021 Q2(c)** and **2024 Q2(c)** on Kant's critique of the proofs for God's existence.

## MCQ 36. Freedom under two standpoints

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Consider the following statements about Kant's resolution of the Third Antinomy.

1. As appearance, an action remains subject to natural causality and can be explained within the temporal series.
2. The same agent may be thought under an intelligible standpoint as initiating a series spontaneously, without this becoming theoretical knowledge of freedom.
3. The distinction makes freedom thinkable without dividing the person into two independently existing beings.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 and 3 only

**Answer: C.**

**Statement analysis:** - **1 is correct:** phenomenal causality remains fully governed by the Second Analogy. - **2 is correct:** the intelligible standpoint removes contradiction but does not furnish speculative proof that freedom is actual. - **3 is correct:** the two-aspect reading concerns one agent considered under different standpoints, not two separately existing selves.

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: it states compatibility but omits the safeguard against turning the standpoint distinction into an ontological duplication. - **B:** Incorrect: it captures thinkability and unity but omits Kant's uncompromised phenomenal determinism. - **C:** Correct: all three statements express “room, not proof” through a standpoint distinction applied to one agent. - **D:** Incorrect: it preserves determinism and the one-agent thesis but omits the intelligible standpoint that makes freedom conceivable.

**Examiner trap 36:** The Third Antinomy neither proves freedom nor weakens natural causality. It removes contradiction by distinguishing standpoints.

**Repair action:** Write one sentence with all limits: the same agent is determined as appearance, thinkable as free intelligibly, and not theoretically known as noumenally free.

**Coverage-cell mapping:** Third Antinomy — specifically freedom as thinkable but not theoretically proved through the standpoint distinction.

**PYQ linkage:** Directly supports **2022 Q3(a)** and prevents overclaiming when the dynamical-antinomies resolution is explained.

## MCQ 37. Why transcendental ideality is not private subjectivity

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Which one of the following most accurately states Kant's position on space and outer objects?

- A. Space is a private image generated separately by each mind, so agreement about objects requires an inference to noumenal causes.
- B. Space is transcendently ideal as a form of human intuition yet empirically real for every possible outer experience, which secures publicly valid objects of experience.
- C. Space belongs to things in themselves, while only the secondary qualities of objects depend on the subject's mode of intuition.
- D. Outer objects are illusions because transcendental ideality denies that appearances can possess objective empirical reality.

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: the form is subject-dependent in a transcendental sense but universal for human experience, not a private image varying by individual. - **B:** Correct: transcendental ideality concerns independence from our sensible constitution, while empirical reality secures objective and intersubjective spatial experience. - **C:** Incorrect: Kant denies that space characterises things in themselves and does not reproduce Locke's primary/secondary-quality division here. - **D:** Incorrect: appearance is not illusion; objective empirical criteria operate wholly within the field of appearances.

**Examiner trap 37:** "Subjective" is dangerously ambiguous. Kant means dependent on the universal form of human sensibility, not privately invented or empirically unreal.

**Repair action:** Pair the terms every time: transcendently ideal *of things in themselves*, empirically real *for all possible outer experience*.

**Coverage-cell mapping:** Transcendental Aesthetic — specifically why transcendental ideality does not make space or spatial objects privately subjective.

**PYQ linkage:** Directly sharpens **2019 Q4(a)** and **2022 Q1(e)** by preventing the Berkeleian misreading of Kant's doctrine of space.

## MCQ 38. The temporal schema as a third thing

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Consider the following statements about transcendental schematism.

1. A category is purely intellectual, while an empirical intuition is sensible and singular.
2. A schema mediates because it is a rule produced by imagination and a determination of time, the form in which every appearance is given.
3. A schema is not a representative image; it supplies the general procedure by which a category can determine sensible objects.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

**Answer: D.**

**Statement analysis:** - **1 is correct:** the heterogeneity of pure concepts and sensible particulars generates the mediation problem. - **2 is correct:** time is sensible as the form of inner sense yet universal enough to correspond to categorial rules. - **3 is correct:** the schema is a construction rule or temporal procedure, not a determinate picture.

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: it explains why and how mediation occurs but omits the rule/image distinction needed to avoid reducing schemata to pictures. - **B:** Incorrect: it states mediation and procedure but omits the heterogeneity that makes a “third thing” necessary. - **C:** Incorrect: it gives the endpoints and non-image character while suppressing time, the feature that makes mediation possible. - **D:** Correct: all three statements reconstruct the problem, the temporal mediator and its rule-governed character.

**Examiner trap 38:** A schema is not a faint image attached to a concept. An image is determinate; a schema is the rule for generating indefinitely many determinate instances.

**Repair action:** Memorise the bridge: category — intellectual rule; time — universal sensible form; schema — temporal rule; intuition — determinate appearance.

**Coverage-cell mapping:** Schematism — specifically the temporal schema as the homogeneous “third thing” between category and intuition.

**PYQ linkage:** Supports **2018 Q2(b)** and the causal-schema reasoning needed for **2024 Q1(b)** and the Kant half of **2026 Q2(b)**.

## MCQ 39. Irreversible succession in the Second Analogy

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A viewer may apprehend the parts of a house in either order, but must apprehend a ship's downstream positions in an order constrained by the event. What does Kant infer?

- A. Every temporal succession of perceptions counts as objective because all apprehension occurs in time and follows a determinate order.
- B. Objective succession is distinguished by greater vividness and constancy than the freely reversible sequence.
- C. An objective event requires a rule fixing which state precedes and follows, though the particular causal law remains empirically discoverable.
- D. The ship case proves that the cause and effect are simultaneous, since only simultaneity can prevent reversal of apprehension.

**Answer: C.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: apprehension is successive in both the house and ship cases, so succession of perception alone cannot mark an event. - **B:** Incorrect: vividness and constancy are Humean psychological criteria, not Kant's ground of objective time-order. - **C:** Correct: irreversible, rule-determined order constitutes objective succession, while experience must still discover which empirical cause operates. - **D:** Incorrect: the Second Analogy concerns succession according to a rule; simultaneity belongs to the Third Analogy.

**Examiner trap 39:** The ship does not prove a particular causal law. It establishes that an event can be represented as objectively successive only under the concept of rule-governed causality.

**Repair action:** Always use the contrast: both apprehensions successive; house order reversible; event order irreversible; therefore a determining rule is required.

**Coverage-cell mapping:** Second Analogy — specifically why irreversible rule-governed succession marks an objective event.

**PYQ linkage:** Directly strengthens **2024 Q1(b)** and provides the exact Kantian response cross-linked to **2026 Q2(b)**.

## MCQ 40. Crossing Kant's two distinctions

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Which one of the following correctly maps Kant's analytic/synthetic and a priori/a posteriori distinctions?

- A. Analytic judgements are a priori; synthetic judgements may be a priori or a posteriori; analytic a posteriori adds no class because conceptual containment already warrants the judgement.
- B. Analytic judgements become a posteriori whenever their concepts were learned from experience, while every synthetic judgement is necessarily a priori.
- C. Analytic and a priori are interchangeable, as are synthetic and a posteriori, so crossing the distinctions still yields only two genuine classes.
- D. Synthetic a priori judgements are impossible because adding a predicate not contained in the subject always requires a fresh sensory warrant.

**Answer: A.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Correct: one distinction concerns predicate containment and the other source of warrant; their crossing yields analytic a priori, synthetic a posteriori and Kant's crucial synthetic a priori class. - **B:** Incorrect: the empirical acquisition of concepts does not make an analytic judgement a posteriori, and synthetic judgements are not all a priori. - **C:** Incorrect: identifying the axes reproduces the very dogmatic grid Kant overturns by defending synthetic a priori cognition. - **D:** Incorrect: the *Critique* asks how synthetic a priori judgements are possible rather than declaring them impossible.

**Examiner trap 40:** Do not confuse the history of acquiring a concept with the warrant for a judgement. Analyticity concerns containment; apriority concerns justification.

**Repair action:** Redraw the two-axis grid and mark one empty cell: analytic a posteriori. Then place definitions, ordinary experience, mathematics and principles of experience in the remaining cells.

**Coverage-cell mapping:** Analytic/synthetic and a priori/a posteriori — specifically why the apparent analytic-a-posteriori combination is epistemically empty.

**PYQ linkage:** Directly supports **2023 Q1(e)** and **2024 Q1(b)**, where the synthetic-a-priori category must be explained rather than merely named.

## MCQ 41. Kant and Hegel on categories and reality

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With reference to 2026 Q4(b), which comparison is most accurate?

- A. Kant and Hegel both treat the categories as an inherited fixed list whose validity ends at appearances, but Hegel adds a theological proof of the noumenal world.
- B. Kant makes categories empirical generalisations abstracted from experience, whereas Hegel alone regards thought as constitutive of experienced objectivity.
- C. Hegel rejects Kant's constitutive turn and restores a pre-critical model in which thought passively copies an independently ready-made reality.
- D. Kant retains fixed a priori categories and a thing-in-itself limit; Hegel makes categories dialectically self-developing determinations of reality and rejects that fixed boundary.

**Answer: D.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: Hegel rejects both the fixed category table and the permanent appearance/in-itself boundary rather than preserving them. - **B:** Incorrect: Kant's categories are a priori and constitutive of objects of experience, so the constitutive turn begins with Kant. - **C:** Incorrect: Hegel radicalises the constitutive insight by treating thought's determinations as reality's own intelligible development. - **D:** Correct: it identifies the inherited Kantian achievement and the Hegelian transformation on both the category and boundary axes.

**Examiner trap 41:** Two separate summaries do not answer the comparison. The decisive axes are fixed versus self-developing categories and limiting noumenon versus dialectically knowable reality.

**Repair action:** Use a four-column matrix: source of categories; relation of thought/reality; role of contradiction; status of thing in itself/Absolute.

**Coverage-cell mapping:** Kant–Hegel comparison — specifically fixed categories and the thing-in-itself boundary versus dialectical self-development.

**PYQ linkage:** Directly maps to **2026 Q4(b)** on the different ways Kant and Hegel conceive the relationship between reality and thought.

## MCQ 42. From failed God-proofs to practical postulates

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Which one of the following preserves the proper boundary between Kant's speculative critique and his practical sequel?

- A. Once speculative proofs fail, practical reason supplies theoretical knowledge of God through the moral law and thereby completes speculative theology.
- B. Speculative reason neither proves nor disproves God; practical reason postulates God for the highest good without converting rational belief into theoretical cognition.
- C. The practical postulate repairs the ontological proof by adding moral perfection to the concept of the most real being and deriving existence from it.
- D. Kant's critique excludes every rational role for God, so mentioning practical postulates contradicts the Dialectic and abandons critical limits.

**Answer: B.**

**Option explanations:** - **A:** Incorrect: practical postulation changes the rational role of the idea but never produces speculative or theoretical knowledge. - **B:** Correct: Kant is theoretically agnostic, while practical reason permits a bounded rational belief connected with the highest good. - **C:** Incorrect: the postulate does not repair any speculative proof or infer existence from an enriched concept. - **D:** Incorrect: the Dialectic blocks constitutive theoretical knowledge but leaves a legitimate practical employment.

**Examiner trap 42:** “Kant disproves God” and “Kant proves God morally” are symmetrical errors. The exact position is failed speculative demonstration plus bounded practical postulation.

**Repair action:** End a God-proof answer in two sentences only: theoretical reason neither proves nor disproves; practical reason postulates God for the highest good, without knowledge.

**Coverage-cell mapping:** God-proofs and practical reason — specifically the bounded relation between speculative critique and practical postulates without importing a full ethics answer.

**PYQ linkage:** Directly supports **2021 Q2(c)** and **2024 Q2(c)** while preserving the topic-owner boundary stated in the existing toolkit.